NORTHSTAR TECHNOLOGIES
PVT. LTD.

EMPLOYEE OFFBOARDING SOP

A controlled and secure process for employee separation and access closure

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Purpose. This SOP defines a consistent process for managing employee departures, transferring work, recovering company assets, closing system access, and retaining or handling company information appropriately. It is designed to reduce operational disruption and prevent access from remaining active after it is no longer required.

CONFIDENTIAL – ADMINISTRATIVE USE. This document contains internal HR and operational process guidance. Access is restricted to authorized administrators and personnel with an approved business need.

Fictional demonstration document for the OnBoardIQ sample knowledge base. It is not a formally approved corporate policy, legal advice or a substitute for applicable employment law, contracts or company-specific procedures.

1. Purpose and expected outcomes

Offboarding begins when an employee's separation is formally initiated and continues through the completion of administrative, technical and operational closure activities. The process must be coordinated, appropriately confidential and proportionate to the circumstances of departure.

The intended outcomes are a documented separation record, orderly knowledge and work handover, recovery or reassignment of company assets, timely access revocation, appropriate data retention, and closure of relevant HR and payroll activities.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to employees of Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. and, where relevant, may be adapted for interns, contractors or temporary personnel through the responsible engagement owner. It covers voluntary resignation, retirement, end of fixed-term employment, termination, role or entity transfer where access must be changed, and other approved separation scenarios.

The ADMIN_ONLY access scope limits retrieval of this procedure to authorized administrators under the platform's access-control rules. It does not automatically authorize every administrator to view every employee's confidential HR records.

3. Roles and responsibilities

- **Human Resources (process owner):** validates the separation instruction, maintains the official case record, coordinates communications, confirms applicable dates and tracks completion.
- **Employee's manager:** plans work transition, identifies business-critical knowledge and assets, confirms handover and nominates owners for open work.
- **IT Operations:** coordinates account, device, credential, network and application access changes according to the approved schedule and security direction.
- **Finance / Payroll:** reviews final salary, approved reimbursements, recoveries and other settlement items under applicable rules.
- **System and data owners:** review access to specialist systems, service accounts, repositories, shared resources and business data.
- **Departing employee:** completes reasonable handover activities, returns company property and follows confidentiality and information-handling obligations.

4. Initiation and case validation

- Receive the separation notification through an approved HR or management channel.
- Verify the employee's identity, employment record, separation category, last working day and authorized approver.
- Confirm whether the departure is planned, immediate, subject to a notice period or requires restricted handling.
- Create an offboarding case with a unique reference, responsible HR coordinator, target dates and task owners.
- Record only information necessary to administer the separation. Restrict sensitive reasons and supporting records to authorized HR and decision-makers.
- Identify legal holds, investigations, preservation requirements or other restrictions before any data or account is deleted.

5. Separation planning and communication

- Agree the offboarding timeline with HR, the manager and relevant operational teams.
- Determine when the employee will be informed and when access changes must occur; access timing must follow the authorized instruction and security risk.
- Prepare a role-specific checklist covering systems, devices, facilities, projects, customer responsibilities and financial processes.

- Identify high-risk access such as production administration, privileged cloud accounts, source-code repositories, finance systems, customer data and security tooling.
- Communicate only the information each stakeholder needs to perform their assigned tasks.

6. Work handover and knowledge transfer

- Prepare a list of active projects, assigned tickets, operational duties, customer commitments, pending approvals and recurring responsibilities.
- Assign a receiving owner for each critical activity and record handover status.
- Transfer business documentation, runbooks, design notes, approved credentials or secrets through authorized secure mechanisms—not through personal email or informal messages.
- Review ownership of repositories, dashboards, scheduled jobs, alerts, shared mailboxes, service integrations and team resources.
- Ensure that personal accounts are not used as the sole owner of business-critical resources.
- Record incomplete handover items, their risk and the person responsible for follow-up.

7. Company property and physical access

- Issue a company-asset return checklist covering laptops, desktops, mobile devices, chargers, access cards, keys, tokens, storage media and other assigned equipment.
- Record each asset identifier, condition, return date and receiving custodian.
- If an asset cannot be returned, record the reason and escalate it to HR and the responsible asset owner.
- Coordinate facility access-card and physical-key deactivation with the facilities or security owner.
- Do not inspect personal content on a device except where explicitly authorized and handled under applicable law and company procedure.

8. Identity, application and infrastructure access closure

IT Operations must execute access changes using the approved identity and access-management process. The schedule should be coordinated with HR and the authorized manager, while urgent security concerns may require immediate action under incident procedures.

- Disable or remove the employee's interactive sign-in access at the authorized time.
- Revoke active sessions, refresh tokens, API tokens, personal access tokens, VPN access, MFA factors and other credentials as applicable.
- Remove access to email, collaboration tools, HR systems, finance applications, source repositories, cloud consoles, databases, ticketing systems and internal portals.
- Review privileged roles, group memberships, shared folders, distribution lists and delegated permissions.
- Rotate shared secrets or credentials if the departing employee had access and the security owner determines rotation is necessary.
- Transfer ownership of approved shared resources, scheduled tasks, dashboards and automation workflows.
- Disable or reassign service accounts only after confirming that they are not shared operational identities required by production services.
- Record completion evidence, responsible operator and timestamp for material access changes.

9. Data, records and information handling

- Preserve business records in approved company repositories and maintain access according to the relevant data owner.
- Transfer ownership of work files, documentation, email workflows and project artifacts where authorized.

- Apply retention schedules, legal holds and investigation requirements before deleting, archiving or modifying records.
- Do not automatically delete an employee's mailbox, files or work product at the moment access is disabled; follow approved retention and transfer procedures.
- Remove local company data from returned devices through the approved asset-wipe or re-provisioning process.
- Handle personal information and confidential HR records with restricted access and approved retention controls.
- Document any exception where information cannot be recovered, transferred or retained as expected.

10. Finance, payroll and benefits closure

- Confirm the last working day and approved attendance or leave records with HR and the manager.
- Review salary, notice-period treatment, approved expenses, reimbursements, recoverable advances and other settlement components.
- Coordinate final payroll and statutory or benefits-related processing under applicable law, contracts and current company policy.
- Collect required acknowledgements or declarations through approved channels.
- Record outstanding items, dependencies, owner and expected resolution date.
- Do not disclose payroll or benefits details to stakeholders who do not have an authorized need to know.

11. Exit communication and feedback

- Where appropriate, HR may schedule an exit discussion to collect feedback about the employee experience, role, management, tools and workplace processes.
- Explain the administrative steps still pending, including asset return, final documents and contact channels for follow-up.
- Store exit feedback in the designated HR system with access limited to authorized personnel.
- Avoid promising a particular outcome, settlement date or reference unless it has been confirmed by the responsible authority.

12. Special handling scenarios

Immediate or involuntary separation: HR and the authorized decision-maker coordinate the exact communication and access-revocation time with IT Operations. A risk-based access restriction may be required before or at notification.

Suspected misconduct or security incident: follow the incident-response process, preserve evidence and coordinate with authorized HR, Legal and Security stakeholders. Do not alert unauthorized parties or alter evidence.

Extended absence or unreachable employee: HR determines the applicable process and documents contact attempts and approvals. Asset and access decisions must follow authorized policy.

Internal transfer: treat the event as a controlled access review. Remove permissions no longer needed and grant new permissions only after the receiving manager or system owner approves them.

13. Completion verification and case closure

- Confirm that all assigned tasks have a named owner and completion status.
- Verify access removal across primary identity systems and critical applications; investigate any account that remains active.
- Confirm company assets are returned, transferred or formally recorded as outstanding.
- Confirm handover of critical work and ownership of shared resources.
- Confirm that payroll, benefits and required HR documentation have been processed or assigned for follow-up.
- Record exceptions, residual risks, approvals and outstanding actions.

- Close the case only when mandatory tasks are complete or an authorized owner has accepted and documented the remaining actions.

14. Escalations and exceptions

Missed access-revocation deadlines, missing assets, unresolved ownership, suspected data exfiltration, disputed records or incomplete mandatory tasks must be escalated to the relevant HR, IT Operations, manager or security owner.

An exception must include the affected control, reason, business impact, risk assessment, compensating control, accountable approver and expiry or review date. Exceptions must not silently bypass access or data-protection requirements.

15. Offboarding checklist

- HR separation instruction validated and case reference created.
- Separation date, category, approver and communication plan confirmed.
- Manager handover plan and receiving owners recorded.
- Company assets and physical access items returned or exceptions documented.
- Identity, application, privileged and remote access revoked at the authorized time.
- Tokens, sessions, MFA factors and shared secrets reviewed as applicable.
- Business data, records and resource ownership transferred or retained appropriately.
- Finance and payroll tasks completed or assigned.
- Exit discussion and required acknowledgements completed where applicable.
- Exceptions, evidence and outstanding actions reviewed; case closure approved.

16. Records and audit trail

The offboarding case should retain the minimum evidence necessary to demonstrate completion, including the initiating approval, checklist status, asset disposition, access-closure confirmations, handover record, exception approvals and case-closure date. Records must be stored in approved systems with role-appropriate access and retention.

Document review and governance

Human Resources should review this SOP at least annually and after material changes to employment processes, identity systems, asset controls or security requirements. IT Operations and other process owners should review the sections relevant to their responsibilities. Updates must be versioned and communicated to authorized stakeholders.

End of document. Fictional Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. demonstration artifact for the OnBoardIQ sample knowledge base. All procedures and examples are illustrative.